

Work through this block by block. Blocks A and B are done at home, C to E in the field, F afterwards. The most common mistakes are at the end. Read those at least once before your first activation.

## A · At home, the night before

### A1 · Choose the location

- ☐ Reference chosen (ONFF number), or deliberately “no reference” for plain portable
- ☐ Boundaries checked against the official ONFF KMZ. Will I really be inside?
- ☐ Gridsquare of the location looked up (6 characters, e.g. JO20qe)
- ☐ Access and parking checked; is permission needed?

### A2 · TQSL

- ☐ Station Location created for this site, under ON3VZ/P
- ☐ Named by convention: place or reference + grid, e.g. ONFF-0599 Alouette JO20xx
- ☐ DXCC Belgium · CQ 14 · ITU 27 · correct gridsquare

### A3 · Log4OM

- ☐ Configuration ON3VZ-P portable loaded, not the shack configuration
- ☐ Station Callsign = ON3VZ/P
- ☐ Operator Callsign = ON3VZ
- ☐ Station Gridsquare = today's grid
- ☐ Station configuration: QMX + Band Hopper IV, power 5 W
- ☐ LoTW Station ID points to the correct Station Location
- ☐ For a WWFF activation: My Sig = WWFF, My Sig Info = ONFF-xxxx
- ☐ Without WWFF: leave My Sig and My Sig Info empty
- ☐ Test QSO entered, ADIF fields verified, test QSO deleted again

### A4 · WSJT-X

- ☐ Configuration Portable loaded
- ☐ My Call = ON3VZ/P
- ☐ My Grid = today's grid
- ☐ Rig = QRPLabs QMX on the correct COM port, PTT method = CAT
- ☐ Poll interval 2 to 3 s, not the default 10 s
- ☐ “Halt Tx when SWR is above 2.5” enabled, PWR and SWR display on
- ☐ Audio in and out = USB sound card of the QMX
- ☐ UDP forwarding to Log4OM enabled
- ☐ PSK Reporter spotting enabled, so reach is measured even without QSOs
- ☐ Hamlib on a stable release, not a release candidate

### A5 · PoLo, for SSB and later CW

- ☐ Operator call ON3VZ, station call ON3VZ/P
- ☐ New activation created with the correct reference
- ☐ Power set to 5 W
- ☐ Offline datafiles refreshed, so callsign lookup works without a network
- ☐ Self-spotting enabled

**A6 · Backup and power**

- ☐ Log4OM database exported to OneDrive
- ☐ TQSL backup up to date
- ☐ Battery, laptop, phone and power bank all fully charged

**B · Packing****Radio**

- ☐ QMX + USB-C cable
- ☐ Battery, cables and fuse
- ☐ DC-DC buck converter and Powerpole leads
- ☐ Headphones
- ☐ G7UFO Turret microphone (for SSB)

**Antenna**

- ☐ Band Hopper IV. The 80 m section stays coiled on its winders
- ☐ Tactical 7000hds mast + ground spike or tripod
- ☐ Guy lines and pegs
- ☐ Coax, kept as short as possible
- ☐ Clip-on ferrites for the feedline
- ☐ SWR meter or analyser
- ☐ Throw line in case the mast cannot be used

**Logging**

- ☐ Laptop + charger (for FT8)
- ☐ iPad or phone with PoLo (for SSB)
- ☐ Paper backup log and pen. Always works

**Everything else**

- ☐ Chair or mat, rain gear, water, food
- ☐ Phone with the ONFF KMZ available offline
- ☐ Camera or phone for the mandatory photos

**C · On site, before the first QSO****Power**

- ☐ Converter output read at 11.50 V on its own display, before the radio is connected

*The QMX accepts 6.0 to 12.0 V. A charged 12 V LiFePO4 sits above 13 V.*

**Antenna**

- ☐ GPS check: am I inside the boundaries of the reference?
- ☐ Antenna up, links set for the starting band
- ☐ Same number of links closed on BOTH legs, counted on both sides
- ☐ Dipole ends out of reach of walkers, at least 2 m high
- ☐ SWR measured before the first transmission. The QMX has no ATU

## Software

- ☐ Log4OM: correct configuration? Check the title bar
- ☐ WSJT-X: correct call and grid? Check the title bar
- ☐ Clock synchronised. FT8 fails without accurate time
- ☐ Photos taken: at least two, or one with GPS location

*Without photos ONFF will reject your log. Do this now, not afterwards.*

## D · During the activation

### Every session

- ☐ Self-spot posted, with the reference and “5W QRP” in the comment
- ☐ Park-to-park: the other station’s reference noted
- ☐ At least 60 minutes on the air, counted from the first QSO

### After every band change

- ☐ Links changed on BOTH legs, counted
- ☐ SWR measured again before transmitting
- ☐ WSJT-X dial frequency matches the radio
- ☐ Self-spot repeated

## Daylight band plan

### Where to start

- 20 m** The daytime workhorse. Widest reach, most hunters active
- 40 m** Early morning and late afternoon. Where the Benelux hunters are
- 30 m** When 20 and 40 disappoint. No contests, no SSB

## E · Packing up

### Before driving off

- ☐ Time of the last QSO noted
- ☐ Antenna and mast fully recovered, nothing left behind
- ☐ All pegs pulled out of the ground
- ☐ Rubbish taken along
- ☐ Log exported or synchronised

## F · At home, after the activation

### F1 · Consolidate the log

- ☐ For SSB: export ADIF from PoLo and import into Log4OM
- ☐ For FT8: QSOs are already in Log4OM via UDP, verify
- ☐ Check MY\_SIG and MY\_SIG\_INFO, or add them in bulk
- ☐ Check TX\_PWR = 5 on all QSOs
- ☐ Clean up duplicates and errors

## F2 · Upload

- ☐ LoTW, using the correct Station Location for that day
- ☐ QRZ Logbook ON3VZ/P
- ☐ Club Log, under the call ON3VZ/P
- ☐ QRZCQ

## F3 · WWFF

- ☐ Export ADIF containing only the QSOs of this activation
- ☐ Filename exactly: on3vz\_p@ONFF-xxxx YYYYMMDD.adf
- ☐ Attach photos, maximum 600 px, or one photo with GPS position
- ☐ Email to onfflogapproval@gmail.com
- ☐ Mention "5W QRP" in the email. This triggers the QRP exception to the 44 QSOs
- ☐ Is there also a POTA reference? Then upload to POTA separately

## F4 · Back to the home configuration

- ☐ Log4OM back on the shack configuration
- ☐ WSJT-X back on the home configuration
- ☐ CAT ports back to the IC-7300 (COM5 / COM6)

## The mistakes people make most often

| Mistake                                                | Consequence                                                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Forgetting to switch configuration                     | QSOs in the wrong logbook and the wrong call sent to LoTW              |
| Leaving the old gridsquare in place                    | Wrong distances and an incorrect location in your confirmations        |
| Taking no photos                                       | ONFF rejects the log, and you only find out once you are home          |
| Wrong filename for WWFF                                | The log is not processed; the filename is the duplicate check          |
| Transmitting without measuring SWR after a band change | Risk of damage to the PA. The QMX has no ATU                           |
| Connecting the radio straight to the battery           | Over 13 V into a radio rated 6.0 to 12.0 V. Regulate to 11.50 V first  |
| Different links closed on the two dipole legs          | Not a dipole any more. High SWR and current on the outside of the coax |
| Leaving the WSJT-X poll interval at 10 s               | Transmitting on the previous band's dial frequency after a change      |